

Drill Pack

Blind ID Drills · Both Directions · Error Log

Week 6 · Inspection (Observation) · Lecture 6

TCM for Ballroom Dancers

reMarkable Edition

How drilling differs from studying: Reading builds understanding. Drilling builds **speed**. You can understand every table in the Study Guide and still blank under time pressure — these drills fix that. Fifteen minutes daily beats two hours on Sunday, and that’s not a motivational claim, it’s how the effect works.

PART A · Blind ID — Five Colors of the Face & Eyes

Heads Up — Cover the right column. Read the description, name the color/pattern out loud, then uncover. Target: all items in under 3 minutes, twice consecutively.

Description (cover the right)	Answer
Entire face red, exogenous fever or zang-fu yang hyperactivity	Excess-type Yang heat
Malar (cheek) flush only, tidal fever, night sweats	Yin-deficiency heat
Bright white, puffy/bloated appearance	Yang Qi deficiency
Withered pale complexion	Blood deficiency
Whole-body yellow including eyes/skin	Jaundice General finding — see next two rows for subtype
Bright orange jaundice	Yang jaundice Damp-heat
Smoky dark jaundice	Yin jaundice Cold-damp or chronic blood stagnation
Pale + blue tinge, severe epigastric/abdominal pain	Excess yin/cold
Blue-purple face+lips, precordial pain	Heart blood stagnation
Pale-dark complexion, lumbar soreness, cold feet	Kidney Yang insufficiency
Bright yellow (tangerine-peel) eyes	Damp-heat, heat predominant
Deep yellow + bloodshot eyes	Toxic heat in the blood level
Red entire eye + headache, easily angered	Rising Liver fire
Blue-green eyes with tremor, dizziness, numbness	Liver wind
Dark sclera, crab-eye black	Accumulated heat
White rings around the iris	Turbid phlegm

PART B · Blind ID — Five Wheels, Nose & Ears

Description (cover the right)	Answer
Inner & outer canthus	Blood Wheel → Heart
Sclera (whites of the eye)	Qi Wheel → Lung
Iris (colored part)	Wind Wheel → Liver
Pupil	Water Wheel → Kidney
Eyelids (upper=Spleen, lower=Stomach)	Flesh Wheel → Spleen/Stomach
Green/blue tip of nose	Cold
Yellow tip of nose, with thirst/sweating	Damp + Heat
Red bridge of nose	Liver fire
Greenish bridge of nose	Liver Qi stagnation
Gray tip of nose	Impaired water movement → edema
Flaring of the nostrils, high fever	Extreme heat in the Lungs
Edema starting upper body/head	Lung governs water pathways
Edema starting lower body/feet	Kidney source of body fluids
Edema starting four limbs/torso	Spleen transforms/transport water
Dry, withered, burnt-black auricle, chronic illness	Kidney essence consumed
Purulent ear discharge ("Tin Er")	Damp-heat, Liver & Gallbladder
High-pitched tinnitus (cicadas)	Liver
Low-pitched tinnitus (rushing water)	Kidney
Long, full earlobes	Strong constitution
Small, short earlobes	Poor constitution

PART C · Blind ID — Teeth, Gums, Lips/Mouth, Throat

Description (cover the right)	Answer
White, moist sheen, bright/clean teeth	Strong Kidney Qi
Dry teeth, no sheen	Kidney Yin decline
Gray and black teeth, like a black bean	Exhaustion of Yin and Yang
Teeth growing at deviated angles or missing	Insufficient Yangming Qi
Deep red gums with swelling	Excess heat / Stomach fire
Pale gums	Blood deficiency
Blue line between teeth and gums	Mercury poisoning
Pale lips	Blood deficiency
Blue-purplish lips	Retention of cold OR blood stagnation
Crimson lips	Yin-deficiency heat
Purple lips	Blood stasis stabbing pain
Deviated mouth	Wind
Mouth remains open + high fever, thirst, canker sores	Excess heat
Mouth slightly open	Deficiency pattern
Deep red throat/pharynx	Heat
Pale red throat	Empty (deficiency) heat
Acute redness/swelling of throat	Wind invasion (exterior)
Chronic sore, dry throat, NOT swollen/red	Lung and/or Kidney Yin deficiency, empty heat
Swollen tonsils, normal color	Damp/phlegm retention, background Qi deficiency
Acutely red/swollen tonsils with exudate	Wind-heat invasion with toxic heat

PART D • Blind ID — Hair, Nails & Skin

Description (cover the right)	Answer
Premature graying of hair	Depletion of Kidney essence
Dull, brittle hair, easily broken	Kidney essence or Liver Blood deficiency
Hair falling out in patches	Blood deficiency within the channels
Nail bed blanches, returns to color immediately	Sufficient Qi and Blood
Nail bed returns to color slowly	Exhaustion of Qi and Blood
Ridged nails	Kidney Yin deficiency / Liver Yang rising
Spoon-shaped nails	Qi/Blood stagnation, malnutrition, Spleen deficiency
Bluish veins on thenar eminence	Cold in the Stomach
Yellow, orangish skin	Damp-heat, more heat than damp
Yellow, dusky skin	Damp-heat, more damp than heat
Pitting edema	Yang edema — Spleen/Kidney Yang deficiency
Non-pitting edema	Qi stagnation or dampness
Papule	Raised, red, seed-sized, fades with pressure
Macule	Flat, red patch, does NOT fade with pressure
Yong (Yang-type carbuncle)	Internal accumulation of fire toxins
Ju (Yin-type carbuncle)	Insufficient Qi/Blood + internal stagnation

PART E · Blind ID — Secretions Logic & Pediatric Diagnosis

Description (cover the right)	Answer
Color: white	Cold
Color: yellow	Heat
Quantity: profuse	Cold
Quantity: scanty	Deficiency / heat (dries fluids)
Quality: thick, sticky	Excess / heat
Quality: thin, clear, watery	Deficiency / cold
Odor: none/faint	Cold
Odor: strong	Heat
Wind Gate only (1st segment)	Mild illness / exterior pathogen
Qi Gate (2nd segment)	Interior condition, stronger illness
Life Gate (3rd segment)	Severe illness
Beyond Life Gate to fingertip	Life-threatening
Light red infant vein, not very visible	Normal
Bright red infant vein	Heat
Purple infant vein	Stronger heat, creating stasis
Green or dark blue infant vein	Wind
Left index finger examined in...	Boys
Right index finger examined in...	Girls

Error Log

Heads Up — Every time you miss a drill item, log it here. Review this page before your next drill session — your errors are more valuable than your correct answers.

Item I Missed	Correct Answer / Why I Missed It